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CUET UG

Political Science

Nation-Building and Its Problems

Official Syllabus · Politics in India Since Independence · Class 12 · CUET UG 2027 Cycle Notes

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Syllabus Alignment

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer (NTA CUET(UG) Political Science syllabus 2026, the current 2027 baseline — Politics in India Since Independence)	Skills the questions test
Nehru's approach to nation-building	Nehru's approach to nation-building — shaping unity out of diversity while keeping democracy alive	Explaining the twin tasks of 1947 and the philosophy behind Nehru's answers.
Legacy of partition: refugees and Kashmir	Legacy of partition: challenge of 'refugee' resettlement, the Kashmir problem	Recalling the scale of displacement, the resettlement response, and the Kashmir accession sequence.
Organisation and reorganisation of states; language	Organisation and reorganisation of states; political conflicts over language	Tracing the commission-to-Act ladder from Dhar to 1956, the later splits, and the Hindi-English duel.

EXAM PATTERN

CUET UG pattern (NTA official information bulletin and syllabus, 2026 cycle — the current 2027 baseline): each subject paper carries **50 compulsory questions** in **60 minutes**, with +5 for every correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer. This unit is the date-and-number unit of the paper — 565 states, 1953's fast, 1956's Act, 1965's agitation — so precise recall converts directly into marks.

What Nation-Building Meant in 1947

Independence arrived as a package deal with two enormous tasks. First, India was not yet a single political unit — British provinces and 565 princely states had to be melted into one country. Second, that one country had to be held together WITHOUT force — through democracy, the very system Europe thought a poor, divided society could not sustain. Nehru's generation had to do both at once.

- **The two challenges the NCERT names:**
  - **Shape a united nation:** the map was a mosaic — provinces ruled directly by the British, princely states ruled by kings, and communities split by the new Pakistan border.

- **Establish democracy:** the Constituent Assembly was writing the Constitution while the country burned — and elections on universal franchise were promised within four years.

- **Nehru's method — accommodation, not uniformity:**
  - India's identity would be **unity in diversity**: many languages, faiths and cultures inside one constitutional frame — not one language or one religion imposed on all.
  - **Secularism as a practical promise:** after Partition's communal bloodbath, Muslims who stayed in India had to feel (and be treated as) equal citizens — not as a suspect minority.
  - **Institutions over charisma:** the Election Commission, the Constitution, federal bargaining — democracy was to rest on rules that outlive any leader.
  - **Where force was used, it was surgical:** Hyderabad's police action, for instance — the default tool was negotiation.

THE RENOVATION JOB

Nation-building in 1947 was like renovating a huge ancestral house DURING a monsoon: the roof (unity) leaked, the wiring (administration) was colonial-era, and half the family (Pakistan) had just moved out taking furniture (Partition). The mapping: the mosaic map = the cracked walls; refugees = the displaced relatives needing rooms; language quarrels = disputes over which nameplate hangs on the door. You cannot stop the rain — you fix fast, bargain constantly, and keep the family (democracy) living together. That is exactly the spirit behind the next five sections.

The Legacy of Partition: Resettling the Refugees

Partition was the loudest birth-cry of the two countries. The boundary award split Bengal in the east and Punjab in the west through mixed, living communities — so millions woke up on the "wrong" side of a line drawn by a barrister who had never visited India.

- **The human scale:**
  - **Communal violence** swept both sides of the border; lakhs of people were killed and huge areas of Punjab, Bengal, Delhi and the United Provinces saw burning villages and trains of the dead.
  - **About 80 lakh refugees** crossed INTO India from Pakistan — the largest single migration of the twentieth century; a matching flow went the other way.
  - **Who they were:** Punjabi farmers and shopkeepers from west Pakistan; Sindhi traders; Bengali families from the east — entire occupations and neighbourhoods uprooted at once.
- **The resettlement challenge — bigger than shelter:**
  - **Physical survival first:** refugee camps in Delhi, Calcutta, Jalandhar and Kurukshetra ran on famine rations through 1947-48; cholera and winter killed the weakest.

- **Jobs and land:** the west-flowing refugees were farmers arriving on OTHER people's land — India responded with land allotments, compensation bonds and new townships (Faridabad grew out of a camp; Sindhi refugees built whole new markets).
- **Identity and citizenship:** refugees had lost homes, documents and sometimes graves of ancestors — the state's answer was fast citizenship and the promise that India, not Pakistan, was now their nation.
- **The political meaning:** the resettlement effort happened while the Constitution was being drafted — it hardened the secular commitment: India would be the homeland of ALL its citizens, of every faith, and Muslims in India were NOT second-class members.

- **Gandhi's answer to the riots:**
  - While Calcutta burned in September 1947, the 77-year-old Gandhi **walked its streets unarmed and fasted** until Hindu, Muslim and Sikh leaders signed a peace pledge — violence stopped in days.
  - **30 January 1948:** a Hindu nationalist assassinated him — the price of the peace he preached. The martyrdom strengthened the young republic's resolve for a secular state.

Integrating 565 Princely States

The British Crown had ruled about 45% of India directly; the rest sat under 565 princes who owed allegiance to the Crown — and with the Crown gone, each one could technically walk away. A subcontinent of independent kingdoms would have meant a thousand borders, customs posts and wars. Fusing them into the Union by 15 August 1947 is the least-told miracle of 1947.

- **The tool — the Instrument of Accession:**
  - Rulers ceded just THREE subjects to the Union: **defence, external affairs and communications** — everything else stayed theirs for the moment. Limited surrender made signing easy.
  - **The team:** Sardar Patel as Deputy Prime Minister + **V.P. Menon** as the tireless civil-service negotiator — running the States Department, flying state to state, offering carrots (privy purses, titles) and gentle sticks (no participation in the Union's institutions).
  - **The result:** by 15 August 1947 almost all states had signed. Travel from Delhi to Madras no longer needed a passport.
- **Three holdouts became exam legends:**
  - **Junagadh — the plebiscite route:** a Muslim ruler (the Nawab) governed a Hindu-majority state next to Pakistan's coast. He acceded to PAKISTAN; India blockaded, the Nawab fled, and in February **1948 a plebiscite** voted overwhelmingly for India. Majority sentiment won.
  - **Hyderabad — the police action:** the Nizam — India's richest man — wanted independence, while his paramilitary **Razakars** terrorised villagers. After 13 months of failed talks, India launched **"police action"** in September 1948; the Nizam signed within days. Force, used once, precisely.
  - **Kashmir — the unfinished story:** the only Muslim-majority state with a Hindu ruler — and a border touching both new countries. Detailed in the next section.
- **The north-eastern edge:**

- **Manipur and Tripura:** princely states merged through negotiated agreements in 1949 after popular movements pressed for representative government.
- **The Naga hills:** Naga leaders had already declared independence (1947); the area became a CENTRALLY administered territory and only became the state of **Nagaland in 1963** — the first of the north-eastern states. Integration here took patience that the west never needed.

THE THREE HOLDOUTS ON ONE LINE EACH

- **Junagadh:** Hindu majority + Muslim ruler → plebiscite (Feb 1948) → India.
- **Hyderabad:** landlocked giant + Nizam's Razakars → police action (Sept 1948) → accession.
- **Kashmir:** Muslim majority + Hindu ruler + tribal invasion (Oct 1947) → Hari Singh accedes → war and permanent dispute.

The Kashmir Problem: The Dispute That Never Closed

Kashmir mattered beyond its size because BOTH new countries claimed it — India by the ruler's legal accession, Pakistan by its two-nation logic (a Muslim-majority area should be Pakistan's). The collision produced the subcontinent's longest-running dispute.

- **The accession sequence (learn it as a chain):**
  - **The setting, 1947:** Maharaja **Hari Singh** — a Hindu ruler of a Muslim-majority state — hesitated between India, Pakistan and independence; **Sheikh Abdullah's** National Conference, the state's popular movement, leaned toward India.
  - **October 1947:** Pashtun **tribal invaders**, backed by Pakistan, poured toward Srinagar, looting as they came. Hari Singh, his option of neutrality destroyed, signed the **Instrument of Accession** (26 October 1947).
  - **The airlift:** Indian troops flew into Srinagar and pushed the raiders back from the valley.
  - **1948 — internationalisation:** India took the question to the UN (January 1948); a **ceasefire (January 1949)** froze the battle lines into a **ceasefire line** — today's Line of Control — leaving roughly a third of the territory Pakistani-administered.
- **Inside the Indian framework:**
  - **Article 370:** because the accession was limited (defence, external affairs, communications), the Constitution gave Jammu & Kashmir **special status** — its own constitution and autonomy over internal matters.
  - **Delhi Agreement (1952):** Nehru and Sheikh Abdullah settled the state's relationship with the Union — Abdullah wanted maximal autonomy; disagreement followed, and in **1953 he was dismissed and jailed** — the first rupture between Srinagar and Delhi.
  - **The wars:** 1947-48, 1965, 1971 (and later conflict beyond this chapter) — each froze the same line but never settled the claim.

- **The two dimensions (the exam-ready phrase):** an **external** dimension (India-Pakistan rivalry over the territory) and an **internal** dimension (how much autonomy the state should enjoy) — both trace back to 1947.

THE HOUSE WITH TWO DEEDS

Think of a house sold under pressure during a burglary. India's deed = the Instrument of Accession the owner (Hari Singh) actually signed — legally airtight. Pakistan's claim = the neighbourhood's majority logic — "the area should belong to us by population." The burglary (tribal invasion) forced the sale, the police (Indian army) arrived after signing, and the property line (ceasefire line) froze where the fight stopped. Both sides still wave their papers seventy years on — which is why the dispute outlived every generation of negotiators.

Organisation and Reorganisation of States

Independent India inherited a chaotic internal map: British provinces drawn for colonial convenience, princely states of every size, and four categories of "accustomed" entities inside the Union. Redrawing the map on DEMOCRATIC lines — the people's languages, not the Raj's revenue maps — was the next nation-building battle, and it went through refusals, a martyrdom and a commission.

- **Why language mattered so much:**
  - The Congress itself had promised **linguistic provinces since 1921** — its provincial committees were organised on language lines. The demand was democratic, not disruptive.
  - But **Partition changed the mood:** a country torn apart on religious lines now feared that redrawing states on language lines would start the same infection. Unity came first — initially.
- **The two refusals (1948-49):**
  - **Dhar Commission (1948):** examined the question right after independence and ruled that **administrative convenience**, NOT language, should decide state boundaries.
  - **JVP Committee (1948-49):** the Congress's own panel — **Jawaharlal Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel, Pattabhi Sitaramayya** — reached the same verdict: language as the basis was too dangerous for the moment.
  - **The effect:** public feeling in Telugu, Tamil, Kannada and Marathi regions kept building regardless — refusals could slow the demand but not kill it.
- **The martyrdom — Potti Sriramulu:**
  - A Gandhi-era freedom fighter, Sriramulu **fasted for a Telugu state** separated from Madras. He died on **15 December 1952** — day 58 of the fast.
  - **The explosion:** riots and public fury across the Telugu country forced Delhi's hand within days.
  - **Andhra State (October 1953):** carved out of Madras — the FIRST linguistic state of India, with Kurnool as capital. The dam had cracked.

- **The lesson Delhi learned:** ignoring democratic linguistic feeling was more dangerous than accepting it.

- **The States Reorganisation Act (1956) — the big map:**
  - **The commission:** the **States Reorganisation Commission (SRC)** — **Fazl Ali, K.M. Panikkar, H.N. Kunzru** — set up in 1953, reported in 1955. It accepted language as a basis BUT with unity safeguards: national integrity first, administrative viability second.
  - **The Act (August 1956, effective 1 November 1956): 14 states and 6 union territories** — the map finally spoke the people's languages (Madras, Mysore, Bombay, Punjab… each roughly a language zone).
  - **After-shocks (each one a favourite question):**
    - **Bombay split (1960):** Marathi and Gujarati agitation broke the bilingual giant into **Maharashtra and Gujarat**.
    - **Nagaland (1963):** the special north-eastern accommodation.
    - **Punjab reorganisation (1966):** the Punjabi Suba movement (Akali Dal) won a Punjabi-speaking state; **Haryana** was carved out and hill areas went to Himachal Pradesh.

Body / event	Year	Verdict or outcome
Dhar Commission	1948	Rejected language; administrative convenience first
JVP Committee	1948-49	Reconfirmed the rejection — Nehru, Patel, Pattabhi Sitaramayya
Potti Sriramulu's fast and death	1952	58-day fast; died 15 December; Andhra followed in 10 months
Andhra State	Oct 1953	First linguistic state, carved from Madras
States Reorganisation Commission	1953-55	Fazl Ali, Panikkar, Kunzru — language accepted with safeguards
States Reorganisation Act	1956	14 states + 6 union territories from 1 November
Bombay split	1960	Maharashtra and Gujarat
Nagaland	1963	First north-eastern state carved as accommodation
Punjab reorganisation	1966	Haryana created; hill areas to Himachal Pradesh

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Political Conflicts Over Language

Redrawing the map settled the STATES question — but the NATIONAL language question stayed open: what should the whole country speak to itself? The Constitution's compromise satisfied no one completely, and the south's resistance shaped the answer.

- **The constitutional start:**
  - **Hindi in Devanagari script** became the official language of the Union; **English** continued for **fifteen years** (till 1965) as the transition language.
  - **The Eighth Schedule** listed **14 scheduled languages** at the start (the list now stands at 22).
  - **The fear in the south:** a Hindi-majority democracy could become a Hindi-majority culture — government jobs, education and opportunity would flow to Hindi speakers. Madras saw this as internal colonialism by alphabet.
- **Nehru's answer — the assurance (1959):**
  - Nehru promised Parliament that **English would remain as long as the non-Hindi states wanted it** — an assurance that calmed the south through the 1950s.
  - **Official Languages Act (1963):** the promise became law — English would continue beyond 1965 for official purposes.
- **The storm — Madras, January 1965:**
  - When 1965 approached, Tamil distrust flared anyway: **anti-Hindi agitations** filled Madras state — students burned Hindi signboards, two young men **self-immolated**, deaths followed, and the state's politics radicalised (the DMK rode this wave to power in 1967).
  - **The resolution:** the Centre backed OFF — Hindi was never imposed; English stayed as associate official language. The republic proved it could absorb the loudest democratic protest without breaking.
- **The settlement's vocabulary (quote these precisely):**
  - **Three-language formula:** in schools — the regional language + Hindi + English (adopted in the 1960s).
  - **No single-language nationalism:** the Hindi-English-regional triangle became permanent national policy.
  - **The point examiners reward:** India solved its language conflict by ACCOMMODATION — the opposite of neighbouring states that imposed one language and bred separatism.

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THE OFFICE NOTICE BOARD

Imagine a huge office where different floors speak different languages. Hindi speakers form the biggest floor and propose: "everyone's notice board goes in OUR language from next year." The smaller floors refuse — they fear losing every promotion to better Hindi readers. The manager's fix: keep the old English boards running as long as any floor wants them, allow each floor's own language too, and train everyone bilingually. The mapping: floors = states; notice boards = official language; the manager = Nehru's Centre; the training rule = the three-language formula. Nobody is thrilled — everybody stays.



Figure 1: 1947′s three fronts on one board: partition and the 80-lakh refugees, the 565-state integration with its three holdouts, and the language-to-states ladder from Dhar to the 1956 Act — with the traps between them.

Evaluating Nehru's Nation-Building

- **What worked:**
  - **The mosaic held:** 565 states integrated, a linguistic map accepted, a language war settled by concession — India stayed one country where many predicted collapse.
  - **Democracy deepened WHILE the map was redrawn:** the loudest movements (Andhra, Bombay, Punjab) ended in new STATES inside the Union, not secessions from it.
  - **Secularism survived Partition's aftershocks** — the refugee resettlement and the minority guarantee gave Indian nationalism a civic, not religious, identity.
- **The costs and hesitations (mention both for balance):**
  - **Kashmir's autonomy bargain** froze into a permanent dispute — the accession was real, but the promise of a plebiscite and UN involvement kept the wound open.
  - **The initial refusals (Dhar, JVP)** bought two years of distrust — Sriramulu's death might have been avoided with an earlier compromise.
  - **Hyderabad's police action** showed the state would use force when talks failed — efficient, but the memory complicated Centre-Deccan relations.
- **The one-line verdict:** Nehru's approach treated diversity as a resource, not a threat — and every crisis of this chapter ended in ACCOMMODATION, which is why the union endured.

Key Facts & Terms: One-Stop Revision

NATION-BUILDING AND ITS PROBLEMS — EVERY FACT ON ONE PAGE

Term / fact	Meaning / statement	Exam use
Two challenges of 1947	Shape one nation from the mosaic + establish democracy	Framing questions on the chapter
Partition's human cost	Lakhs killed; about 80 lakh refugees entered India	Scale-recall questions
Refugee resettlement	Camps, land allotments, townships, fast citizenship	Policy-response questions
Gandhi's last fast	Calcutta Sept 1947 peace pledge; assassinated 30 Jan 1948	Person-event matching
565 princely states	Integrated by Patel + V.P. Menon via the Instrument of Accession	Integration questions
Instrument of Accession	Rulers ceded defence, external affairs, communications ONLY	Scope-of-accession traps
Junagadh	Plebiscite Feb 1948 joined India	Holdout matching
Hyderabad	Police action Sept 1948 vs Nizam and Razakars	Holdout matching
Kashmir accession	Tribal invasion Oct 1947 → Hari Singh signs (26 Oct) → airlift → war → ceasefire Jan 1949	Sequence questions
Article 370 / Delhi Agreement	Special status from limited accession; Nehru-Abdullah pact 1952; Abdullah dismissed 1953	Autonomy questions
Dhar Commission / JVP	1948 / 1948-49 — BOTH rejected language as the basis	"which body said what" traps
Potti Sriramulu	Fasted 58 days for Telugu state; died 15 Dec 1952	Martyrdom-and-date questions
Andhra State	Oct 1953 — first linguistic state (from Madras)	First-of questions
SRC	Fazl Ali, Panikkar, Kunzru; 1953-55; language accepted with safeguards	Commission-matching
1956 Act	14 states + 6 UTs from 1 Nov 1956	Number-recall questions

Term / fact	Meaning / statement	Exam use
Later splits	Bombay → Maharashtra + Gujarat 1960; Nagaland 1963; Punjab → Haryana 1966	After-shock questions
Language provisions	Hindi official, English 15-year transition, 8th Schedule 14 languages	Constitutional questions
Nehru assurance + 1963 Act	English continues as long as non-Hindi states want — made law 1963	Assurance-matching
Madras 1965	Anti-Hindi agitation; self-immolations; Hindi never imposed	Agitation questions
Three-language formula	Regional + Hindi + English in schools	Compromise questions

Common Errors & Special Cases

THE TRAPS THIS UNIT SETS — READ BEFORE THE MOCK

The rule you assume	The twist	The trap in the question
"Nehru integrated the princely states"	The Sardar ran the operation — Patel + V.P. Menon, States Department	Credit-attribution questions
"Accession = full merger"	Rulers ceded only defence, external affairs, communications	Scope-of-accession traps
"Junagadh and Hyderabad ended the same way"	Junagadh: plebiscite; Hyderabad: police action — two different instruments	Method-matching
"Language-based states were opposed till the end"	SRC (1953-55) ACCEPTED language — Dhar and JVP were the refusers	Commission-verdict pairing
"Andhra Pradesh was the first linguistic state"	Andhra STATE (1953) came first; Pradesh is the 1956 enlarged version	Name-precision traps
"English was to end in 1965"	The 1963 Act kept English; the 1965 agitation buried the deadline forever	Language-policy questions

The rule you assume	The twist	The trap in the question
"Hindi became THE national language"	The Constitution made it OFFICIAL language of the Union — "national language" is the classic wrong phrase	Terminology traps
"Kashmir acceded after the war"	Accession (26 Oct 1947) came BEFORE the full war and ceasefire	Sequence questions

The 60-Second Self-Test

Cover the answers, say each one aloud, then check. If any answer takes longer than ten seconds, revisit that section.

- **The two challenges of 1947?** → Shape one nation out of the mosaic AND establish democracy — at the same time.
- **About how many refugees entered India after Partition?** → Around 80 lakh — the century's largest migration.
- **Which three subjects did rulers cede by the Instrument of Accession?** → Defence, external affairs, communications.
- **Match the holdouts to their endings.** → Junagadh — plebiscite 1948; Hyderabad — police action Sept 1948; Kashmir — accession Oct 1947 then war.
- **Which two bodies REJECTED language as the basis of states?** → Dhar Commission (1948) and the JVP Committee (1948-49).
- **Who fasted for Andhra, for how long, and with what result?** → Potti Sriramulu — 58 days — died 15 Dec 1952; Andhra State came in Oct 1953.
- **What did the SRC and the 1956 Act deliver?** → Language accepted with safeguards; 14 states + 6 union territories.
- **What did Nehru promise in 1959, and what law kept it?** → English stays as long as non-Hindi states want — the Official Languages Act 1963.
- **What happened in Madras in January 1965?** → Anti-Hindi agitation; self-immolations; Hindi was never imposed.
- **Why did Delhi hesitate on linguistic states right after 1947?** → Partition had just split the country on identity lines — language-based division looked like the same danger.
- **Name the two dimensions of the Kashmir problem.** → External (the India-Pakistan territorial rivalry) and internal (how much autonomy the state should enjoy).

The Whole Chapter in One Picture



Figure 2: Chapter mindmap: Nehru's approach, partition and refugees, the 565-state integration, Kashmir's accession chain, the reorganisation ladder and the language duel — with the traps that catch most students.

Practice Questions (Exam Pattern)

Ten questions in the CUET UG style. Attempt all of them — the paper gives +5 for each correct answer and −1 for every incorrect answer.

Q1. The number of princely states that existed in India at the time of independence was about:

(A) 562 (B) 565
(C) 570 (D) 550

Q2. The task of integrating the princely states into the Indian Union was led by:

(A) Jawaharlal Nehru with Maulana Azad (B) Rajendra Prasad with T.T. Krishnamachari
(C) C. Rajagopalachari with K.M. Munshi (D) Sardar Patel with V.P. Menon

Q3. India's FIRST linguistic state, created in October 1953, was:

(A) Kerala
(B) Maharashtra
(C) Andhra State
(D) Punjab

Q4. The States Reorganisation Act of 1956 reorganised India into:

(A) 14 states and 6 union territories
(B) 16 states and 5 union territories
(C) 14 states and 9 union territories
(D) 25 states and 7 union territories

Q5. The Dhar Commission (1948) recommended that state boundaries be drawn on the basis of:

(A) language
(B) administrative convenience rather than language
(C) economic zones
(D) population density

Q6. The ruler who signed the Instrument of Accession for Jammu & Kashmir in October 1947 was:

(A) Hari Singh
(B) Ranbir Singh
(C) Gulab Singh
(D) Karan Singh

Q7. The special constitutional status of Jammu & Kashmir within the Indian Union was embodied in:

(A) Article 356
(B) Article 365
(C) Article 370
(D) Article 372

Q8. The large-scale anti-Hindi agitation of January 1965 broke out in:

(A) Kerala
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Mysore
(D) Madras state (Tamil Nadu)

Q9. In 1960 the bilingual Bombay State was divided into:

(A) Maharashtra and Karnataka
(B) Maharashtra and Gujarat
(C) Gujarat and Rajasthan
(D) Maharashtra and Goa

Q10. The Punjab Reorganisation Act (1966) created which new state from Punjab's Hindi-speaking areas?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Chandigarh as a state
(C) Haryana
(D) Uttarakhand

Detailed Solutions

Each solution shows the reasoning, not just the verdict — cover the answer line, attempt the question, then compare.

Sol. Q1. The States Department under Patel and Menon negotiated with about 565 princely states — the number the NCERT and exam sources fix. 552 signed by August 1947; the rest followed through 1948.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q2. Sardar Patel (Deputy PM) and V.P. Menon (States Department) ran the integration — persuasion, privy purses, and the Instrument of Accession. Nehru handled the wider vision; the Sardar handled the map.

Answer: (D)

Sol. Q3. Andhra State — carved from Madras after Potti Sriramulu's 58-day fast ended in death on 15 December 1952. Kerala, Maharashtra and Punjab all became (or were reorganised as) states only in 1956 or later.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q4. The Act gave effect to the SRC's map: 14 states and 6 union territories from 1 November 1956. The 16-state and 25-state figures belong to later decades of reorganisation.

Answer: (A)

Sol. Q5. The Dhar Commission put administrative convenience first and refused language as the basis — the JVP Committee (Nehru-Patel-Pattabhi) confirmed that refusal in 1948-49.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q6. Maharaja Hari Singh signed on 26 October 1947 as tribal raiders backed by Pakistan advanced on Srinagar; Indian troops were airlifted the next morning. Gulab Singh was the dynasty's 19th-century founder — a dynasty distractor.

Answer: (A)

Sol. Q7. Article 370 embodied the special status that flowed from Kashmir's LIMITED accession (defence, external affairs, communications). Articles 356 and 365 are President's rule provisions — constitutional distractors.

Answer: (C)

Sol. Q8. The January 1965 agitation swept Madras state when the 1965 deadline for English's phase-out approached; self-immolations and deaths forced the Centre to keep English. Kerala, Andhra and Mysore were not the epicentre.

Answer: (D)

Sol. Q9. Marathi and Gujarati agitations split bilingual Bombay into Maharashtra and Gujarat on 1 May 1960. Karnataka and Rajasthan were never part of that state.

Answer: (B)

Sol. Q10. The 1966 Act carved Haryana out of the Hindi-speaking south-east of Punjab and sent hill areas to Himachal Pradesh; Chandigarh became a union territory shared as capital.

Answer: (C)

Wrong-Answer Clinic — the one-line corrections

Dropped marks above? Find your slip here and rewrite the corrected rule in your own words.

If you answered...	Your slip was...	The corrected rule, in one line
Q2 option A	Crediting Nehru with the map-work	Nehru led the vision; PATEL + Menon led the integration — pair the operation with its operator
Q3 option A	Confusing Kerala's 1956 creation	Andhra State (1953) is the FIRST linguistic state; Kerala arrives with the 1956 Act
Q5 option A	Mixing the refusers with the accepter	Dhar and JVP refused language; the SRC (1953-55) accepted it with safeguards
Q6 option C	Taking the dynasty's founder for the ruler	Gulab Singh founded the dynasty in 1846; Hari Singh was the 1947 ruler
Q7 option A	Grabbing the nearest famous article	356/365 = President's rule; 370 = J&K special status; 372 = continuance of existing laws
Q10 option D	Importing a later state backwards	Uttarakhand comes from UP in 2000 — the 1966 split is Haryana

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